

Marketplace Research Plan

Identifying Users, Buyers, and Target Market

- **Primary Users:** People who cook at home and use the kitchen countertops a lot
- **Buyers:** Busy parents and young adults, countertop supplier shops, furniture depots, disinfecting stores, household accessories stores
- **Target Market:** People who spend a lot of time cleaning the kitchen, making sure that it is stain-free and properly disinfected
 - **Busy Households:** Spend a lot of time working, traveling, focusing on vacations and cannot afford to set aside time to clean countertops
 - **Young Adults:** May not be clean with cooking and food preparation while also juggling work and education priorities
 - **Senior citizens and people approaching old age:** Bodies may ache just from being engaged in cleaning back-breaking work and could lead to quick exhaustion

Collection of Data

- **Research Tools:**
 - **In person interviews:** Live interviews with people who struggle with cleanliness and mental health.
 - **Online surveys:** Send out google form surveys asking about the 3 targeted issues. (Bacteria, time, mental health)
 - **Live demonstrations:** In the field examples of people cleaning, how long they take, and the efficiency of them (online videos)
 - **Forum Chats:** Accessing data/opinions of users online from discussions
- **Type of Respondents Targeted:**
 - Parents/stressed individuals who struggle to find time to clean
 - Cleaning companies
 - People who clean homes or are nannies

- **How the Research Will Be Sent:**

- Email
- Text
- Zoom Call
- Virtual/In person interviews
- Posting on forum chats

- **Use of Data:**

- Search specifically where people respond with concerns about time inefficiency, mental stress, and/or unhygienic food surfaces
- Look at if people mention other products/methods for cleaning countertops and analyze for dissatisfaction or drawbacks

Citations

Source:

Yepiz-Gomez,M. S. and Bright,K. R. and Gerba,C. P., 20083169044, English, Journal article, USA, 1541-9576, 26, (11), Des Moines, Food Protection Trends, (786–792), International Association for Food Protection, Identity and numbers of bacteria present on tabletops and in dishcloths used to wipe down tabletops in public restaurants and bars., (2006)

Artifact 1:

The study investigates the most common method of cleaning tables and countertops, that being a washcloth/dishcloth. Through their findings they discovered that the majority of these dishcloths unintentionally gather dangerous bacteria on them. Determining that although the numbers went down in countertop bacteria, the dishcloths tracking them also pose a threat.

Artifact Critique:

Once more our problem is justified as businesses are more willing to take shortcuts rather than invest in proper cleaning. Continuing to use dishcloths even if they are potentially contaminated.

Source:

Kathreen, J., Marie, D., Pasag, J.-R., Dumaguit, G., & Nieto, H. C. (2025, May 3). Prevalence of Microbial Contamination in the Countertops of Local Eateries near LORMA Colleges -Campus for Health Sciences.
<https://doi.org/10.13140/RG.2.2.19078.69448>

Artifact 2:

A study was performed at multiple diners, restaurants and other various eateries near LORMA colleges to find how prevalent bacteria is on those countertops , while also providing insight on how effective the cleaning initiative was to prevent them from prevailing. At the end it was decided that the majority of these eateries were doing an insufficient job in eliminating the dangerous bacteria.

Artifact Critique:

The study proves that the majority of public places do not properly clean their countertops, or their methods are inefficient.

Source:

team, N. editorial. (2024, October). Therapy Clean: Transforming Mental Health Through Environmental Wellness. NeuroLaunch.com.
https://neurolaunch.com/therapy-clean/#google_vignette

Artifact 3:

The article presents studies as well as personal accounts of how cleaning has significantly helped their state of mind. The article specifically states how people who tend to be in a cluttered environment without cleaning it tend to have more mental blockage and stress.

Artifact Critique:

This reinforces our claim of how a clean and tidy area helps lower one's stress and helps them have a better state of mind.

Source:

Snyder , P. (1999, March 22). THE REDUCTION OF E. COLI ON VARIOUS COUNTERTOP SURFACES. Qualey Granite.
<https://qualeygranite.com/pdf/Bacteria-and-Granite-Study.pdf>

Artifact 4:

The document is comparing the cleanability to common household materials used for kitchen countertops. They compared the number of E.Coli bacteria before and after cleaning each surface.

Artifact Critique:

This artifact validates how bacteria and hygiene are a common concerns regarding kitchen countertops during and after cooking.

Source:

Fowle, H. J., & Boschen, M. J. (2011, March). The impact of compulsive cleaning on confidence in memory and cleanliness. Science Direct.
<https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0887618510001908>

Artifact 5:

The artifact discusses the repetitive cleaning and checking of surfaces and how it negatively affects confidence and trust.

Artifact Critique:

By having an external solution that cleans the countertop or helps clean the countertop the user will be able to ensure that it is clean every time. This will help to cut down repetitive behaviors because the user is ensured that the surface is clean and will not feel the need to constantly check it.

Source:

Scott, E. (2008, August). A pilot study to isolate *Staphylococcus aureus* and methicillin-resistant *S aureus* from environmental surfaces in the home. Science Direct. <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/abs/pii/S0196655308000436>

Artifact 6:

The article presents statistics to reiterate the importance of hygiene within the household. *S aureus*, a harmful bacteria, was found in 97% of households especially on inanimate surfaces.

Artifact Critique:

This reinforces the need for hygienic solutions to dirty surfaces, especially ones used to prepare food.

Source:

Matthewson, L., BCIT School of Health Sciences, Environmental Health, & Heacock, H. (2017). Methods for cleaning & sanitizing food contact surfaces (countertops) to prevent cross contamination in restaurant kitchens. BCIT Environmental Public Health Journal. <https://doi.org/10.47339/ephj.2017.85>

Artifact 7:

The article talks about the most effective ways to clean a countertop and how the majority of professional cooks don't take adequate measures to ensure hygiene.

Artifact Critique:

This article confirms our statement that proper hygiene practices don't take place even in professional cooking settings and that a solution that will take the proper measures to ensure proper counter-top cleaning procedure will ensure a safe eating and cooking conditions in kitchens.

Source:

<https://www.nytimes.com/wirecutter/guides/how-to-clean-kitchen-countertops#:~:text=Even%20though%20there%20are%20more,you%20finish%20the%20whole%20counter.>

Artifact 8:

This artifact shows the proper procedure to clean a counter top and how to ensure a well cleaned counter-top, including the time range that the activity could take up.

Artifact Critique:

This article proves that counter-top cleaning is a time taking endeavor and that by finding a solution to reduce or eliminate the time it takes to clean a countertop the audience will benefit greatly..

Source:

Richards, G. (2023, October 13). Why Cluttered Countertops Are Holding You Back. Pro Chef Kitchen Tools.

https://prochefkitchentools.com/blogs/tips/why_cluttered_countertops_are_holding_you_back-1

Artifact 9:

The source provides the many ways in how cluttered countertops can lead to mental stress, mainly anxiety and distracted minds. It also talks about the various bacteria populations that thrive as a result of cluttered countertops. Past this, it also talks about how people can also be affected socially by the sight of cluttered and messy countertops and how it may affect their interactions with others.

Artifact Critique:

The source emphasizes how dirty countertops would disturb a person's thought processes, lingering in their minds and causing mental unrest until the countertop is cleaned to satisfaction. This reinforces our claim of how a clean and tidy area helps lower one's stress and helps them have a better state of mind.